

Greece and Bulgaria

Greece and Bulgaria are Orthodox Christian nations and both use the Cyrillic script to write rather than the Latin script common to most other European countries.



Greece

More than 2,500 years ago, Greece was the center of European civilization. Many famous buildings survive from that period.

THE PARTHENON, ATHENS

The Olympics

Ancient Greece was the home of the Olympic Games. Revived in 1896, they were recently hosted by Greece again in 2004.

A rose by any other name...

Bulgarian roses

The petals of Bulgaria's roses are harvested to produce the rose oil used in perfume.

He rose to the occasion.

The Black Sea

Bulgaria's Black Sea coast is a major tourist destination for western Europeans and Russians anxious to enjoy some summer sun.

It's picturesque.



Malta

Sitting at the narrowest point of the Mediterranean between Italy and North Africa, Malta is an important harbor for merchant and naval shipping.

Cyprus

Aside from tourism, farming is the mainstay of Cyprus's economy and Cypriots grow olives for their oil, citrus fruit, and grapes.

I want all of the olives.

Mediterranean Islands

The Mediterranean Sea contains two island republics—Malta and Cyprus. The latter is actually located in Asia, but is European in outlook and a member of the EU.

I try to keep a good outlook.

I'm a man of letters.

San Marino

The world's oldest republic, San Marino generates most of its income through the sale of postage stamps.

The Swiss Guard—protectors of the Pope

Vatican City

The world's smallest independent state lies in central Rome. It is ruled by the pope and is the headquarters of the Roman Catholic Church.



Slovenia

This largely rural nation sits across some of the major road and rail links between west and east Europe, and is attracting increasing numbers of tourists to its Alpine scenery.

I've seen this scene somewhere before.

Italy

Boot-shaped Italy, kicking into the Mediterranean Sea, is renowned for its wealth of beautiful medieval churches and palaces. Its capital, Rome, once commanded a mighty empire that controlled most of western Europe.

I prefer soap operas.

Opera

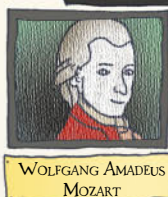
Originating in Italy in the 16th century, opera is still the country's most popular musical form.

Roman ruins

Italy is brimming with remains from the Roman Empire, including the Colosseum in Rome, where gladiators once fought.

Come to Austria for the sound of music.

Blue Danube—a famous waltz by Johann Strauss



WOLFGANG AMADEUS MOZART

Austria

The birthplace of Mozart and the Strauss family, Austria is famous for its music, as well as its delectable Sacher Torte chocolate cake.

Liechtenstein

As asserted in its national anthem, the tiny Principality of Liechtenstein sits on the River Rhine, between Switzerland and Austria.



Mountaineering as a sport began in the Swiss Alps.

Switzerland

Timepieces are a major export industry for the Swiss, who are renowned for their precision engineering.

I'm running late.

The Alps

Four states nestle in the peaks of the Alps—Europe's highest mountain chain—of which Switzerland and Liechtenstein are officially neutral, meaning they are not allied with any other nations.

Central Europe

These landlocked central European nations are highly industrialized, making a wide range of manufactured goods such as cars and other machines, as well as growing much agricultural produce.

Czech glass

The Czech Republic is famous for its quality Bohemian Crystal glassware and decorative arts.

Slovakia

The Tatra Mountains of northern Slovakia are attracting increasing numbers of tourists to their ski resorts.

Czech Republic

Prague, the Czech capital, is one of Europe's most beautiful capital cities, sitting on the River Vltava and dominated by its historic castle.

Hungary

Budapest, the capital of Hungary, was once two cities, with Buda and its magnificent castle on one side of the River Danube and Pest on the other.

Yum!

Goulash soup—Hungary's national dish